JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Scientist with 6 years of experience building machine learning solutions for financial and e-commerce sectors. I've led cross-functional teams to deliver predictive models that directly impact business revenue and operational efficiency. My background spans statistical modelling, Python development, and cloud infrastructure, with a particular interest in solving problems where data is messy and requirements are ambiguous. I thrive when working on projects that require both technical depth and clear communication to non-technical stakeholders.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Scientist

DataFlow Analytics Ltd

https://dataflowanalytics.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Designed and deployed a customer churn prediction model using gradient boosting that identified at-risk accounts 3 months in advance, resulting in retention of GBP 2.4 million in annual revenue for the financial services division.

Led a team of two junior data scientists on a recommendation engine project, providing code reviews and establishing reproducible workflows using Git and Docker to ensure model consistency across development and production environments.

Migrated legacy statistical models from R to Python and containerised them on AWS Lambda, reducing inference latency from 8 seconds to 0.3 seconds and cutting infrastructure costs by 35 percent.

Presented quarterly insights to C-level stakeholders on customer behaviour trends, translating complex statistical findings into actionable business recommendations that informed product strategy.

Data Scientist

Insight Commerce Ltd

https://insightcommerce.co

London, United Kingdom

July 2019 - February 2022

Developed a price optimisation algorithm using time series forecasting and elasticity analysis that improved profit margins by 4.2 percent across a product catalogue of 50,000 SKUs.

Built data pipelines using Apache Airflow and Python to ingest clickstream data from multiple retail touchpoints, processing 500 million events daily with 99.8 percent uptime.

Conducted A/B testing on product ranking algorithms using frequentist statistical methods, validating hypotheses and documenting results in a centralised experiment tracking system.

Collaborated with SQL developers and data engineers to optimise warehouse queries, reducing average query execution time by 45 percent and enabling faster iteration on exploratory analysis.

Junior Data Scientist

Northern Analytics Group

https://northernanalytics.net

Manchester, United Kingdom

September 2018 - June 2019

Analysed user engagement metrics and built cohort analysis dashboards using Tableau that helped the marketing team identify high-value customer segments.

Trained and evaluated classification models for fraud detection using scikit-learn and XGBoost, achieving 94 percent precision on a highly imbalanced dataset with 2.1 million transactions.

Cleaned and validated raw data sources from transactional systems, documenting data quality issues and implementing automated checks to catch anomalies in future data loads.

Supported the development of a customer lifetime value model that segmented clients into risk categories, enabling targeted retention campaigns with improved ROI.

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: September 2018

BSc Statistics with Economics

University of Nottingham

Nottingham, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, SQL, R

Machine Learning: scikit-learn, XGBoost, gradient boosting, logistic regression, time series forecasting, A/B testing, experimental design

Data Engineering: Apache Airflow, Pandas, NumPy, data pipeline development

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, SageMaker), basic GCP experience

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redshift, data warehouse design

Visualisation: Tableau, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly

Version Control: Git, GitHub

Containerisation: Docker, basic Kubernetes

Statistical Methods: Hypothesis testing, Bayesian inference, regression analysis, causal inference